

NJABULO SHABALALA

Junior SOC Analyst | Microsoft Security Stack | Johannesburg, South Africa

njabshabs@gmail.com | 065 831 3984 | [linkedin.com/in/njabulo-shabalala](https://www.linkedin.com/in/njabulo-shabalala) | njabuloshabalala.github.io | Blog: njabuloshabalala.hashnode.dev

PROFILE

Junior SOC Analyst candidate working with the Microsoft Security stack. I have hands-on experience writing KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel and investigating real breach scenarios through KC7 Cyber Labs. I currently hold the ISC2 CC and Microsoft SC-900, with three Microsoft Applied Skills badges in Defender XDR, Purview, and Entra ID. I am actively preparing for the SC-200 exam. I also hold a degree in Organisational Psychology and International Relations from Rhodes University which I believe is helpful for writing clear incident reports and understanding the human factors behind various security incidents. I am looking to join a Microsoft-aligned MSSP or SOC team in South Africa, where I can contribute.

CERTIFICATIONS & APPLIED SKILLS

Certifications

- ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) — ISC2
- Microsoft Certified: Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals (SC-900) — Microsoft
- Microsoft Security Operations Analyst (SC-200) — In progress

Microsoft Applied Skills (Verified)

- Defend Against Cyberthreats with Microsoft Defender XDR
- Implement Information Protection and Data Loss Prevention using Microsoft Purview
- Get Started with Identities and Access using Microsoft Entra

TECHNICAL SKILLS

SIEM / XDR: Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Entra ID, Microsoft Purview

Query & Analysis: Kusto Query Language (KQL), JSON log analysis, Analyzing Azure login data

Core Competencies: Threat detection, incident response, log analysis, threat hunting, RBAC design, identity governance, investigative documentation

Other: Linux fundamentals, GitHub, Microsoft Excel

PORTFOLIO PROJECTS & SECURITY LABS

Full documentation of these projects can be found on: njabuloshabalala.github.io

Dynamic Threat Investigations | KC7 Cyber Labs

- Worked through a realistic election security breach — traced the attacker's activity from the phishing site they set up, through stealing a staff member's credentials, moving through the network, and trying to access voting machine data.
- Used KQL to identify which accounts were compromised, which IPs and domains the attacker controlled, and what internal systems they reached.
- Wrote up findings as a structured incident report covering what happened, what was affected, and what steps were needed to contain the threat.

Threat Detection Engineering & Log Parsing | Microsoft Sentinel / Entra ID

- Triggered repeated failed login attempts against a test Azure environment to generate real sign-in failure logs, then pulled the raw JSON data to examine exactly what fields and values the logs contain.
- Built a KQL detection rule that combines a specific Azure login failure code (ResultType 50126) with outbound network activity to flag potential brute-force or credential-stuffing attacks.

Identity & Access Control Lab (RBAC) | Microsoft Entra ID

- Set up a role structure in Microsoft Entra ID that gives junior analysts read-only access and senior engineers admin access, managed through Security Groups rather than individual assignments.
- Tested whether the access boundaries held by trying actions that lower-privileged accounts shouldn't be able to do — confirmed they were blocked.

Secure Asset Governance & Access Auditing | Microsoft Azure

- Pulled a full list of who has access to what in a test Azure environment, including inherited permissions, and checked each one against the principle of least privilege.
- Wrote an audit report identifying where access was broader than it needed to be and laid out the specific steps to fix it.

EXPERIENCE

Administrative Assistant | Golden Stallion Web Agency (GSWA) *Mar 2025 – Mar 2026*

- Managed CRM and CMS data, wrote SOPs, produced structured reports, and coordinated with vendors — work that required accuracy, clear documentation, and consistent process management.

Sub-Warden | Rhodes University *Nov 2021 – Nov 2022*

- Managed conduct and welfare for 20+ students, enforced policy, and handled escalations — hands-on experience with risk identification, documentation, and following structured procedures.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts — Organisational Psychology & International Relations | Rhodes University, Makhanda

Covers human behaviour in organisations, governance and regulatory frameworks, stakeholder communication, and analytical reasoning.

LANGUAGES

English (fluent) | isiZulu (fluent)